

HOW YOUTUBE CAN IMPROVE DISCOVERY FOR SMALL CREATORS

PROBLEM STATEMENT

As a small YouTube Creator like me - channel name Ashish Snaps , Who grew a YouTube channel organically, I experienced challenges with discoverability despite consistent uploads and quality content. This case study explores how YouTube can improve content discovery for emerging creators.

There are over 113.9 million active channels on YouTube right now. Of those, roughly 32,300 have crossed 1 million subscribers. 32,300 out of 113.9 million is 0.028%, which proves that even if you create a YouTube channel, garnering a million subscribers is as hard as winning an Olympic medal. [~LINK](#)

Small creators struggle to gain visibility because YouTube heavily favors established creators with higher engagement history.

Small Creators often struggle with:

- low impressions on newly uploaded videos
- inconsistent reach despite regular uploads
- difficulty reaching target audiences
- limited understanding of why content underperforms
- competition against already established channels

As a result, many small creators lose motivation and stop uploading before reaching meaningful audience growth. This creates a discovery gap where potentially valuable content fails to reach interested viewers.





USER RESEARCH



ASHISH

Ashish is a 20-year-old engineering student who creates Travel Vlogs and documentary, AI tool reviews, and tech tutorials alongside his academic work. He wants to build a niche audience and eventually collaborate with technology brands.

Personality

- Analytical and experiment-driven
- Passionate about technology and trends
- Creative with content formats and editing styles
- Regularly studies performance metrics and viewer behavior

Pain Points

- Inconsistent reach across uploads
- Recommendation system feels unpredictable
- Videos often stop gaining impressions after the initial push
- Hard to build audience loyalty as a small creator

Needs

- Better exposure to relevant viewers
- Improved creator analytics with personalized suggestions
- More support for niche and emerging creators
- Transparent feedback on content performance and discovery



RIYA

Riya Sharma is a 19-year-old college student who creates educational and productivity-focused content for students preparing for competitive exams. She uploads consistently and aims to grow her channel into a trusted learning community.

Personality

- Ambitious and self-driven
- Consistent with content uploads
- Curious about audience behavior and analytics
- Motivated by long-term growth and impact

Pain Points

- Videos receive very low impressions despite high effort
- Difficult to compete with already established creators
- Struggles to understand why some videos underperform
- Growth feels slow and unpredictable

Needs

- Better visibility for new uploads
- Clearer analytics and actionable insights
- Fair opportunities for small creators to reach audiences
- Improved audience matching and recommendation support

PAIN POINTS

- Low Discoverability for Small Creators
- Inconsistent Video Reach
- Lack of Actionable Analytics
- Limited Initial Exposure
- High Competition Against Established Channels
- Creator Motivation & Retention Challenges



1. Hyper-Local Discovery

- Add a "Near You" discovery tab that surfaces creators from the viewer's city, neighborhood, or region. Small creators often have strong local relevance (local restaurants, events, humor) that gets buried in a global feed. Local fame is the bridge to global fame.

2. Collab Matchmaker System

- An AI-powered tool that matches small creators with similar-sized creators in complementary niches for collaborations. For example:
- A small fitness creator + a small nutrition creator
- A small comedian + a small musician
- Cross-pollination grows both audiences simultaneously
- Collab videos get a 2x algorithmic boost

3. Early Performance Feedback Loop

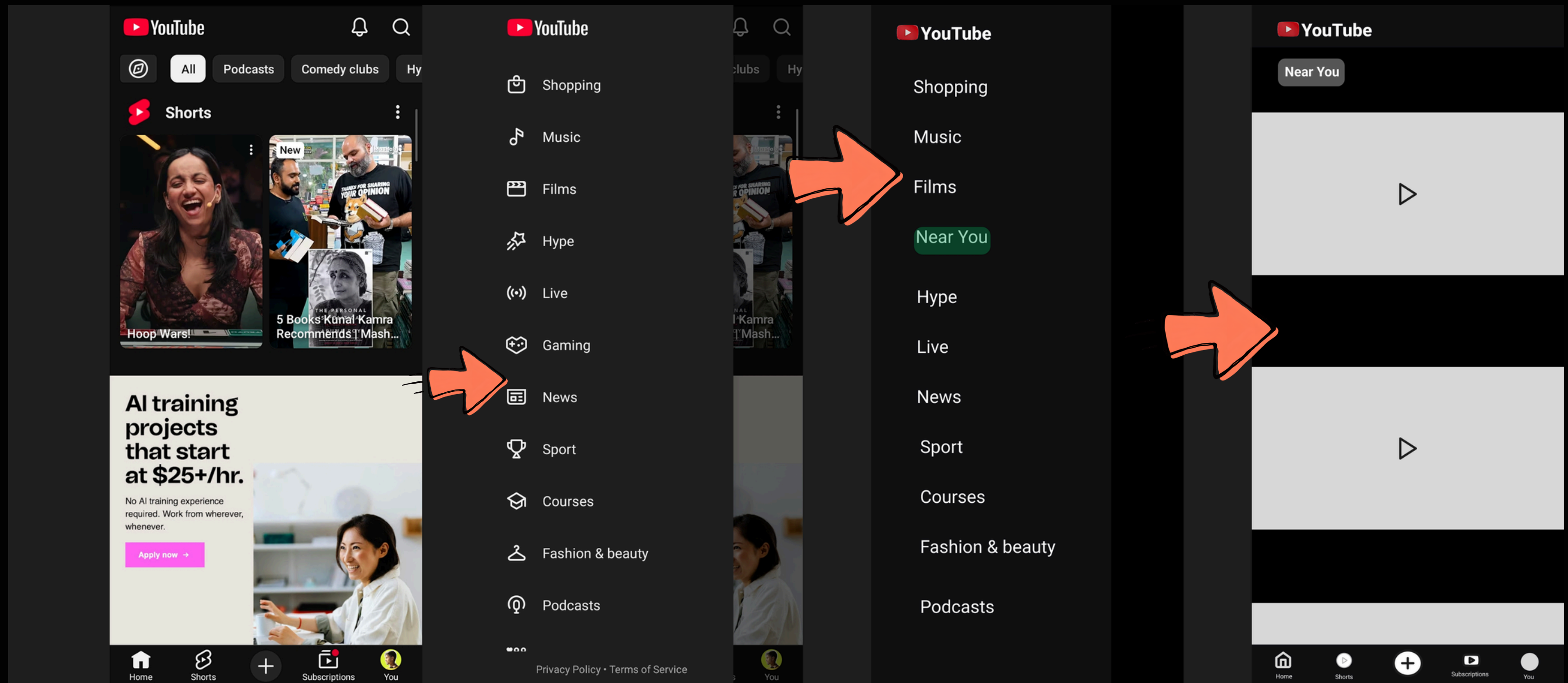
- Provide creators with immediate feedback after upload regarding audience response, retention behavior, and recommendation testing performance during the first few hours.

4. Actionable Creator Analytics

- Upgrade YouTube Studio with clearer insights and personalized recommendations explaining why videos underperform and how creators can improve reach, retention, and click-through rates.

PROPOSED SOLUTIONS

WIREFRAME



SUCCESS METRICS



1. Viewer Engagement
2. Recommendation Diversity
3. Subscriber Growth Rate
4. Small Creator Impressions

The primary success metric for this proposal is an increase in overall viewer engagement across emerging creator content.

Reason -

Improving engagement benefits both YouTube and small creators:

- viewers discover more relevant and diverse content
- small creators receive better exposure opportunities
- YouTube increases user retention and platform activity through a wider variety of engaging content



**THANK
YOU!**